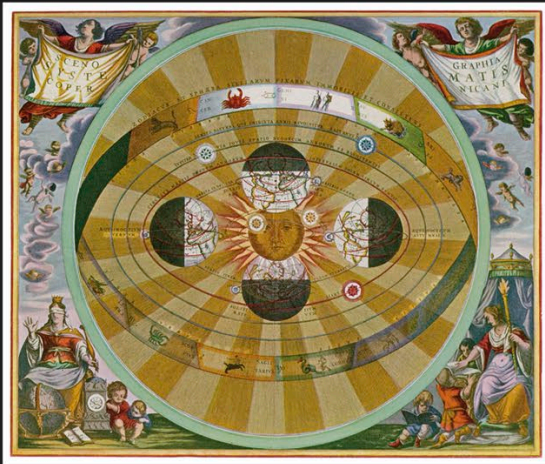


Stargazers

People have studied celestial objects for thousands of years. This study is called astronomy. Around 400 years ago, a special tool was invented that made the task easier – this tool is called a telescope.



Copernicus placed the Sun at the centre of the planets. He “stopped the Sun and moved the Earth”.

Guess what I can see!

The Italian astronomer Galileo Galilei built a simple telescope in 1609 and proved Copernicus had been right. He discovered Venus had phases (like our Moon), he saw Jupiter’s moons, and he spotted mountains on our Moon.



weird or what?

Galileo’s discoveries were not welcomed by the Church in 17th-century Italy, and he spent the last few years of his life under house arrest.

Before the telescope

People were shocked when Polish astronomer Nicolaus Copernicus suggested in 1543 that the Earth was just another planet and the planets orbited (went around) the Sun. Then, it was a common belief that the Earth was at the centre of the Universe.



Saturn as sketched by Galileo – he thought Saturn’s rings were two moons or “ears”.



Saturn as we know it today